



THE NUCLEAR ARMS RACE

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THE U.S. AND U.S.S.R. DETONATE **HYDROGEN** BOMBS



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The United States and the Soviet Union started using hydrogen bombs during the early Cold War, when nuclear weapons were becoming way more powerful and scary.



The U.S. exploded its first H-bomb in 1952, and the Soviet Union tested its own version in 1953, which made the arms race between them even more intense. These new bombs were much stronger than the earlier atomic bombs, which made people around the world more worried and pushed the conflict into a more dangerous stage.

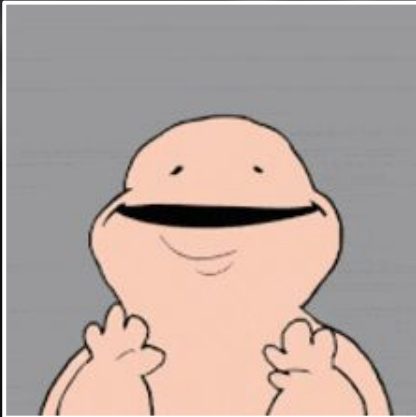


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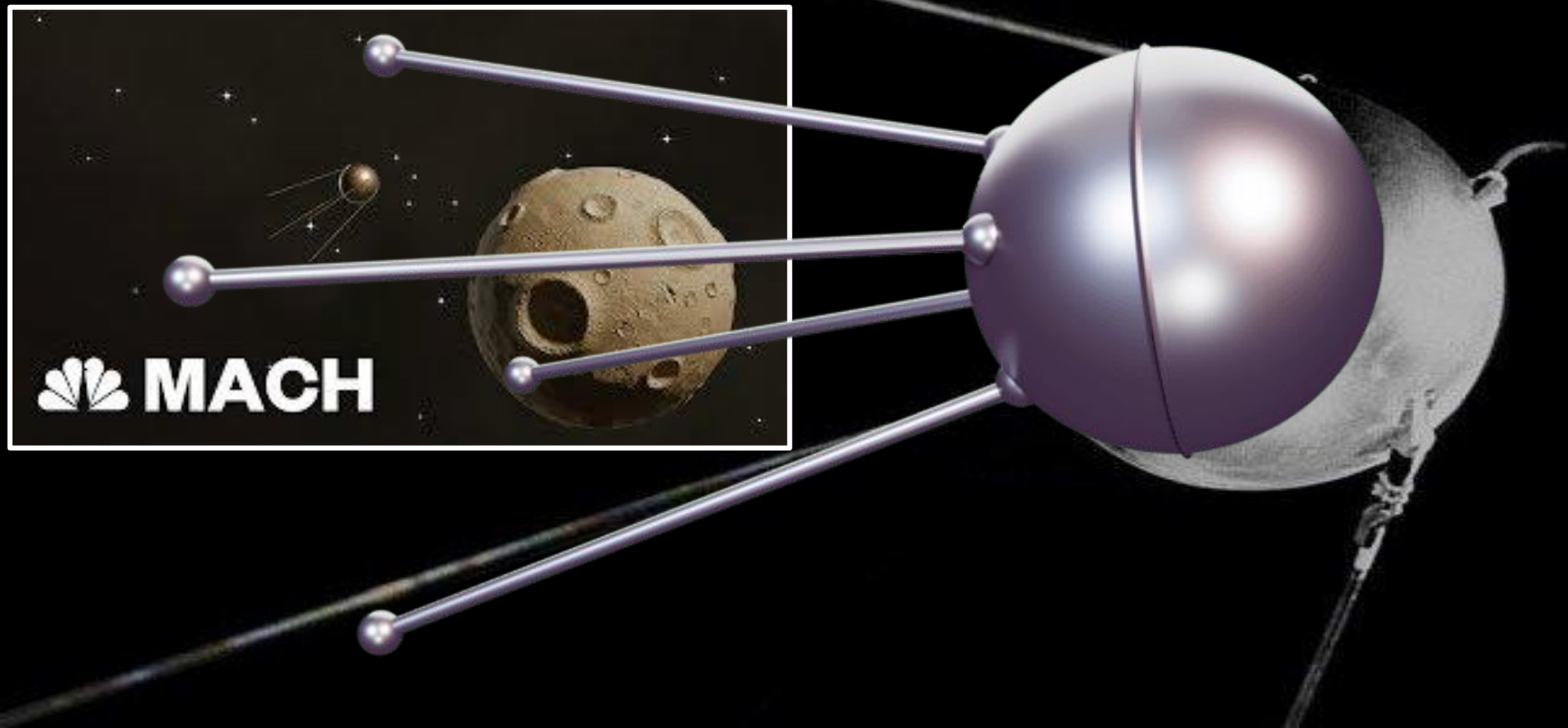
Mutual Assured Destruction (MAD) is a principle of military strategy and security policy that allows the full use of nuclear weapons by an attacker on an armed defender with retaliative abilities. This would end as the complete annihilation of both sides. This strategy could end in nuclear peace since there will be no presence of nuclear weapons and global stability will take away the choice to use nuclear weapons. The term was made by Donald Brennan in 1962, a strategist working at the Herman Kahn Hudson Institute.



To elaborate more on the term M.A.D, If either side attacked for any reason, the other would retaliate with the same or greater force. The result is immediate and irreversible damage to both sides, resulting in complete, total, and guaranteed destruction. This principle requires that each side does not build shelters on a giant scale. If one did, it would violate M.A.D. and destabilize the matter because it would have less to fear from a second attack. The payoff of M.A.D. was and still is expected to be tense but stable peace.



THE SPACE RACE: SOVIETS LAUNCH SPUTNIK 1957



THE SPACE RACE: SOVIETS LAUNCH SPUTNIK 1, 1957

The Space Race began on October 4, 1947, when the Soviet Union launched Sputnik 1, the first artificial satellite. This event shocked the U.S. and was seen as the start of the Cold War between the USSR and the USA.



Its success showed that the Soviet Union could launch objects into space using powerful rockets, which many Americans feared also meant they could launch nuclear-armed missiles. The launch caused a “Sputnik crisis” in the U.S., sparking fear that the country had fallen behind in science, technology, and military capability. This pushed the U.S. to speed up its own space efforts, leading to the creation of NASA in 1958 and the eventual American push to the moon.